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Chitale Committee Recommendation, the Irla Nullah, a conduit for storm water to flow freely to the Arabian Sea, had to be widened by 15 metres. On his visit to Bombay, Prime Minister Manmohan Singh handed the BMC a cheque of 400 crores, the first installment for Brihanmumbai's Storm Water Drain (BRISTOWAD). Now the BMC had the dough to kick-start the Irla Nullah widening project. "But nothing was happening on the ground," Singh recollected. "So my organisation—Juhu Scheme Residents' Association—filed an RTI."

In the file reading of the RTI, numerous details emerged: the tenements eligible for slum relocation, the contractor issued to do the job, the project deadlines. If the money was in place, if the Chitale Committee Recommendation had provided directives, then why wasn't the BMC getting on with the project?

As part of this project, 207 encroachments on either side of the Irla Nullah had to be relocated. Once this was accomplished, a key thorn persisted: the 5,000 sq ft offices of a private business, TRIG, owned by Swaran

After the deluge: The devastating 2005 Mumbai floods killed over 400 people and left many homeless